

Crontab Assignment - Questions and Answers

Question 1: List 3 real-life scenarios where automating tasks with crontab would be useful on a Linux server, and write one line explaining the benefit for each.

Answer:

1. Daily Database Backup – Automatically creates backups and prevents data loss.
2. Log File Cleanup – Removes old logs regularly and saves disk space.
3. Website Monitoring – Checks website availability automatically and helps detect issues quickly.

Question 2: Write a crontab entry that runs a script called `update_playlist.sh` every day at 2:00 AM and explain each part.

Answer:

```
0 2 * * * /home/yourusername/update_playlist.sh
```

Explanation:

0 = Minute (0)

2 = Hour (2 AM)

* = Every day of month

* = Every month

* = Every day of week

/home/yourusername/update_playlist.sh = Script to execute

Question 3: Create a shell script named `backup_instagram_photos.sh` that copies all files from InstagramPhotos to Backups with today's date.

Answer:

```
#!/bin/bash
```

```
DATE=$(date +%F)
```

```
DEST=/home/yourusername/Backups/InstagramPhotos_$(date +%F)
```

```
mkdir -p $DEST
```

```
cp -r /home/yourusername/InstagramPhotos/* $DEST/
```

Question 4: Schedule your backup script to run every Sunday at 11:30 PM and save output to `backup_log.txt`.

Answer:

```
30 23 * * 0 /home/yourusername/backup_instagram_photos.sh >>
```

```
/home/yourusername/backup_log.txt 2>&1
```

Explanation:

30 = Minute

23 = Hour (11 PM)

* = Every day of month

* = Every month

0 = Sunday

>> = Append output to log file

2>&1 = Redirect errors to same log file

Question 5: After your backup runs, open `backup_log.txt` and submit the last 5 lines as proof.

Answer:

Command:

```
tail -5 /home/yourusername/backup_log.txt
```

Example Output:

Backup started...

Creating folder InstagramPhotos_2026-08-03

Copying files...

Backup completed successfully

Total files copied: 150